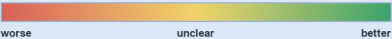


# Grounding Stress-Test Matrix

Cell hue summarizes sanity behavior: green = expected grounding response, red = contradictory support, yellow = unclear / neutral.



| Model             | Supports correct image<br>Expected: support | Rejects wrong answer<br>Expected: reject | Rejects blank image<br>Expected: reject | Rejects shuffled image<br>Expected: reject | Failure fingerprint                       |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Qwen2.5-VL-3B     |                                             |                                          |                                         |                                            | Sees absence, misses mismatch             |
| DeepSeek-VL2 tiny |                                             |                                          |                                         |                                            | Rejects controls, weak positive grounding |

One-glance takeaway: accuracy, control robustness, and explanation grounding are different failure axes.